



Devanāgarī Handwriting Practice Book

अ आ क ख ग

Model Trace Copy Repeat

PRINTABLE PENCIL EDITION

For children, families, classrooms, and adult beginners. Includes every core Classical Sanskrit letter, vowel signs, common conjuncts, basic words, Devanāgarī digits, and generous repetition space.

How to use this book

Short, calm practice builds stronger letter memory.

1

Model

Say the IAST sound. Look at the whole printed form and its proportions.

2

Trace

Move slowly over each pale model. Accuracy matters more than speed.

3

Copy

Look back at the model, then write in the guided cells.

4

Repeat

Cover the model if possible. Retrieve the shape from memory.

A GOOD PRACTICE SESSION

5 minutes: warm-up lines and curves.

10 minutes: one new letter page.

5 minutes: review one earlier page from memory.

Stop before the hand becomes tense. Frequent short sessions are better than one exhausting session.

Pencil, paper, and posture

Comfort first: clear writing comes from controlled, relaxed movement.

PENCIL GRIP

Hold the pencil gently between thumb and index finger, supported by the middle finger. Keep the fingers a short distance from the tip.

PAPER ANGLE

Turn the paper slightly so the writing hand can move naturally. A right-handed and left-handed learner may prefer opposite angles.

POSTURE

Sit with feet supported, shoulders relaxed, and forearms resting comfortably. Keep the page close enough to see without bending low.

PRESSURE

Use light-to-medium pressure. The pale trace models should remain visible under the pencil line, not be carved into the paper.

HEADLINE

Align the śirorekḥā, or headline, with the upper guide. In many teaching styles the main body is formed first and the headline is completed last.

LOCAL CONVENTION

Stroke order can vary slightly by teacher and handwriting tradition. Follow a local teacher's demonstrated order when it differs, while preserving the printed proportions.

ADULT SUPERVISION

For young children, use an age-appropriate pencil and supervise practice. Praise careful observation and relaxed movement, not only perfect results.

Straight paths

Build control for headlines, stems, and diagonals.



Continue the pattern



Continue the pattern



Continue the pattern



Continue the pattern



Continue the pattern



Continue the pattern

MOVEMENT CHECK

Move from the shoulder and wrist as needed. Keep speed slow, spacing even, and pencil pressure light.

Curves and turns

Build control for bowls, shoulders, hooks, and loops.

⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ -----
Continue the pattern

⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ -----
Continue the pattern

⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ -----
Continue the pattern

⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ -----
Continue the pattern

⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ -----
Continue the pattern

⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ ⌋ -----
Continue the pattern

MOVEMENT CHECK

Move from the shoulder and wrist as needed. Keep speed slow, spacing even, and pencil pressure light.

Headline rhythm

Practice body shapes, verticals, and a steady śirorekḥā.

TTTTT

Continue the pattern

rrrrr

Continue the pattern

TTTTT

Continue the pattern

rrrrr

Continue the pattern

TTTTT

Continue the pattern

rrrrr

Continue the pattern

MOVEMENT CHECK

Move from the shoulder and wrist as needed. Keep speed slow, spacing even, and pencil pressure light.

Independent vowels

IAST first, Devanāgarī beside it.

अ a	आ ā	इ i	ई ī
उ u	ऊ ū	ऋ ṛ	ॠ ṝ
ऌ ḷ	ॡ ḹ	ए e	ऐ ai
ओ o	औ au		

HOW TO READ THE MAP

Long vowels use a macron: ā ī ū. Dots and accents in IAST distinguish different Sanskrit sounds; they are not optional decorations.

Consonants by sound group

Each full consonant letter includes an inherent short a.

क ka	ख kha	ग ga	घ gha	ङ ṅa
च ca	छ cha	ज ja	झ jha	ञ ña
ट ṭa	ठ ṭha	ड ḍa	ढ ḍha	ण ṇa
त ta	थ tha	द da	ध dha	न na
प pa	फ pha	ब ba	भ bha	म ma
य ya	र ra	ल la	व va	श śa
ष ṣa	स sa	ह ha	ळ ḷa	

HOW TO READ THE MAP

Long vowels use a macron: ā ī ū. Dots and accents in IAST distinguish different Sanskrit sounds; they are not optional decorations.

Independent vowels



A vowel can stand alone as a full letter. Say the IAST sound first, then trace the Devanāgarī form.

अ आ इ ई

Before you begin

- Long vowels are held longer: ā, ī, ū, ṛ.
- Trace the whole printed model before trying to write from memory.
- Keep the body proportionate and align any headline with the guide.

a • अ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL		Sound cue: short a A relaxed central vowel; keep the body open and balanced.
a	अ	

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

अ	अ	अ	अ	अ	अ
अ	अ	अ	अ	अ	अ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ā • आ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL		Sound cue: long ā
ā	आ	Hold the vowel about twice as long as a.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

आ	आ	आ	आ	आ	आ
आ	आ	आ	आ	आ	आ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

INDEPENDENT VOWELS

i • इ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL

i



Sound cue: short i

Keep the upper curve distinct from the lower body.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

इ	इ	इ	इ	इ	इ
इ	इ	इ	इ	इ	इ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

INDEPENDENT VOWELS

ī • ई

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL ī 	Sound cue: long ī Notice the extra upper movement; do not crowd the headline.
---	---

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

					
					

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

u • उ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL		Sound cue: short u Let the lower curve descend clearly below the body.
u	उ	

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

उ	उ	उ	उ	उ	उ
उ	उ	उ	उ	उ	उ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

INDEPENDENT VOWELS

ū • ऊ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL		Sound cue: long ū Keep both lower movements open and easy to see.
ū	ऊ	

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ऊ	ऊ	ऊ	ऊ	ऊ	ऊ
ऊ	ऊ	ऊ	ऊ	ऊ	ऊ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

r · ऋ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL

r

ऋ

Sound cue: vocalic r

Use the full independent-vowel shape, not a consonant plus a sign.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ
ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ī · ऋ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL

ī

ऋ

Sound cue: long vocalic ī

A less common Classical Sanskrit vowel; copy its full form carefully.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ
ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ	ऋ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

INDEPENDENT VOWELS

३. लृ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL

३

लृ

Sound cue: vocalic ३

A rare Sanskrit vowel; keep its distinctive lower detail.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ
लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

INDEPENDENT VOWELS

ī • लृ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL

ī

लृ

Sound cue: long vocalic ī

A very rare extension; learn it for alphabet completeness.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ
लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ	लृ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

INDEPENDENT VOWELS

e • ए

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL e 	Sound cue: long e Keep the upper diagonal and headline separate and crisp.
---	--

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ए	ए	ए	ए	ए	ए
ए	ए	ए	ए	ए	ए

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ai · ऐ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL ai 	Sound cue: diphthong ai The additional upper mark distinguishes ai from e.
--	--

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ऐ	ऐ	ऐ	ऐ	ऐ	ऐ
ऐ	ऐ	ऐ	ऐ	ऐ	ऐ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

o • ओ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL o ओ	Sound cue: long o Keep the right-side stroke aligned and evenly spaced.
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1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ओ	ओ	ओ	ओ	ओ	ओ
ओ	ओ	ओ	ओ	ओ	ओ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

au · औ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

VOWEL		Sound cue: diphthong au
au		The extra upper mark distinguishes au from o.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

औ	औ	औ	औ	औ	औ
औ	औ	औ	औ	औ	औ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

Sound marks

These marks modify a sound or punctuate Sanskrit text.

am̐

अं

anusvāra ṁ

A nasal marker; its pronunciation adapts to the following sound.

aḥ

अः

visarga ḥ

A breath-like sound after the vowel.

am̐̃

अँ

candrabindu m̐̃

Marks vowel nasalization; especially useful in Vedic and some lexical contexts.

'

ऽ

avagraha

Marks the loss of an initial a after sandhi.

.

। ॥

danda and double danda

Traditional sentence and verse punctuation.

Trace the signs

Move slowly

•	ः	ँ	ऽ	।
॥	•	ः	ँ	।



Consonants

A full Devanāgarī consonant letter normally includes an inherent short a. The sound groups move from the back of the mouth toward the lips.

क च ट त प

Before you begin

- Say ka, kha, ga... rather than isolated English letter names.
- Keep aspirated and unaspirated partners distinct.
- Distinguish retroflex ʈ/ɖ/ɳ from dental t/d/n.

ka · क

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT		Sound cue: k in skate Unaspirated: use little extra breath.
ka	क	

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

क	क	क	क	क	क
क	क	क	क	क	क

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

kha • ख

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

kha

ख

Sound cue: k plus breath

Aspirated partner of ka; keep the loop open.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ख	ख	ख	ख	ख	ख
ख	ख	ख	ख	ख	ख

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ga • ग

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ga

ग

Sound cue: g in go

Voiced; keep the lower curve rounded.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ग	ग	ग	ग	ग	ग
ग	ग	ग	ग	ग	ग

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

gha · घ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

gha

घ

Sound cue: g plus breath

Voiced and aspirated; separate the inner turns.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

घ	घ	घ	घ	घ	घ
घ	घ	घ	घ	घ	घ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ṅa • ङ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ṅa

ङ

Sound cue: ng in sing

A nasal; used mainly in consonant combinations.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ
ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ca • च

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT	ca च	Sound cue: ch in church IAST c represents this unaspirated sound.
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1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

च	च	च	च	च	च
च	च	च	च	च	च

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

cha · छ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

cha



Sound cue: ch plus breath

Aspirated partner of ca.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

छ	छ	छ	छ	छ	छ
छ	छ	छ	छ	छ	छ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ja • ज

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ja

ज

Sound cue: j in joy

Keep the lower bowl open and the stem straight.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ज	ज	ज	ज	ज	ज
ज	ज	ज	ज	ज	ज

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

jha • झ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

jha

झ

Sound cue: j plus breath

Voiced and aspirated; do not lose the inner detail.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

झ	झ	झ	झ	झ	झ
झ	झ	झ	झ	झ	झ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ña • ज

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ña

ज

Sound cue: ny in canyon

A nasal; common inside conjuncts.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ज	ज	ज	ज	ज	ज
ज	ज	ज	ज	ज	ज

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ṭa • ट

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ṭa

ट

Sound cue: retroflex t

Curl the tongue back; keep the written bowl compact.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ट	ट	ट	ट	ट	ट
ट	ट	ट	ट	ट	ट

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ṭha • ṭ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ṭha



Sound cue: retroflex t plus breath

Aspirated partner of ṭa.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ṭ	ṭ	ṭ	ṭ	ṭ	ṭ
ṭ	ṭ	ṭ	ṭ	ṭ	ṭ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ḍa · ङ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ḍa

ङ

Sound cue: retroflex d

Voiced; keep the rounded body below the headline.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ
ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ	ङ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ḍha • ढ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ḍha

ढ

Sound cue: retroflex d plus breath

Keep the lower extension clear.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ढ	ढ	ढ	ढ	ढ	ढ
ढ	ढ	ढ	ढ	ढ	ढ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ṇa · ण

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ṇa

ण

Sound cue: retroflex n

Differentiate it carefully from na.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ण	ण	ण	ण	ण	ण
ण	ण	ण	ण	ण	ण

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ta • त

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ta

त

Sound cue: dental t

Touch the tongue near the upper teeth; keep the hook light.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

त	त	त	त	त	त
त	त	त	त	त	त

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

tha • थ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

tha

थ

Sound cue: dental t plus breath

Aspirated partner of ta.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

थ	थ	थ	थ	थ	थ
थ	थ	थ	थ	थ	थ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

da · द

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

da

द

Sound cue: dental d

Keep the left curve and right stem in proportion.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

द	द	द	द	द	द
द	द	द	द	द	द

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

dha • ধ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

dha

ধ

Sound cue: dental d plus breath

Do not close the lower inner space.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ধ	ধ	ধ	ধ	ধ	ধ
ধ	ধ	ধ	ধ	ধ	ধ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

na · न

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

na

न

Sound cue: n in no

Keep the stem vertical and the lower turn smooth.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

न	न	न	न	न	न
न	न	न	न	न	न

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

pa • प

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

pa

प

Sound cue: p in spin

Unaspirated; keep both verticals steady.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

प	प	प	प	प	प
प	प	प	प	प	प

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

pha · फ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

pha

फ

Sound cue: p plus breath

Classical Sanskrit ph is aspirated p, not English f.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

फ	फ	फ	फ	फ	फ
फ	फ	फ	फ	फ	फ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ba · ब

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT		Sound cue: b in boy Keep the lower loop open.
ba	ब	

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ब	ब	ब	ब	ब	ब
ब	ब	ब	ब	ब	ब

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

bha · भ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

bha

भ

Sound cue: b plus breath

Voiced and aspirated; leave room for the inner curve.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

भ	भ	भ	भ	भ	भ
भ	भ	भ	भ	भ	भ

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ma • म

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ma

म

Sound cue: m in mother

Keep the two lower shoulders even.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

म	म	म	म	म	म
म	म	म	म	म	म

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ya • य

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ya

य

Sound cue: y in yes

Make the lower curve light and the stem straight.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

य	य	य	य	य	य
य	य	य	य	य	य

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ra • र

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ra

र

Sound cue: flapped or rolled r

This full form differs from repha and other conjunct forms.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

र	र	र	र	र	र
र	र	र	र	र	र

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

la • ल

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

la

ल

Sound cue: l in light

Keep the tall stem straight and lower loop clear.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ल	ल	ल	ल	ल	ल
ल	ल	ल	ल	ल	ल

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

va • व

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT	va व	Sound cue: between v and w Keep the lower bowl distinct from ba.
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1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

व	व	व	व	व	व
व	व	व	व	व	व

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

śa • श

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

śa

श

Sound cue: palatal sh

IAST acute ś; keep all three lower elements distinct.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

श	श	श	श	श	श
श	श	श	श	श	श

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ṣa • ष

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ṣa

ष

Sound cue: retroflex sh

IAST dotted ṣ; distinguish it from śa and sa.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ष	ष	ष	ष	ष	ष
ष	ष	ष	ष	ष	ष

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

sa • स

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

sa

स

Sound cue: s in sun

Keep the upper turn and lower body open.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

स	स	स	स	स	स
स	स	स	स	स	स

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

ha · ह

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

ha

ह

Sound cue: h in ahead

Let the left body remain broad enough to read.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

ह	ह	ह	ह	ह	ह
ह	ह	ह	ह	ह	ह

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

la · ऌ

Say the sound, trace the model, then write from memory.

CONSONANT

la

Sound cue: retroflex l

A supplementary regional/Sanskrit letter; not in every basic alphabet.

1. Trace

12 slow repetitions

2. Copy

Look back at the model

3. Repeat

18 spaces - relax your grip

Vowel signs



After a consonant, most vowels are written with dependent signs called mātrās. The inherent a uses no separate sign.

क का की

Before you begin

- Read the complete syllable, not the sign by itself.
- The i sign appears visually before the consonant but is pronounced after it.
- Lower and upper signs must remain attached to the correct consonant.

kā · का

Add the ā sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

ka + ā kā

क + ा = का

right-side vertical

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

का	का	का	का	का	का
का	का	का	का	का	का

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

ki • कि

Add the i sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

ka + i ki

क + ि = कि

written before the consonant but
pronounced after it

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

कि	कि	कि	कि	कि	कि
कि	कि	कि	कि	कि	कि

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

kī • की

Add the ī sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

ka + ī kī

क + ी = की

right-side long i sign

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

की	की	की	की	की	की
की	की	की	की	की	की

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

ku · कु

Add the u sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

short lower sign

ka + u ku

क + उ = कु

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

कु	कु	कु	कु	कु	कु
कु	कु	कु	कु	कु	कु

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

kū · कू

Add the ū sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

long lower sign

ka + ū kū

क + ू = कू

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

कू	कू	कू	कू	कू	कू
कू	कू	कू	कू	कू	कू

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

kr · कृ

Add the ृ sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

lower vocalic-r sign

ka + ृ kr

क + ृ = कृ

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ
कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

kṛ · कृ

Add the ṛ sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

long vocalic-r sign

ka + ṛ kṛ

क + ृ = कृ

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ
कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ	कृ

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

क। • क॒

Add the । sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

rare lower vocalic-। sign

ka + । क।

क + ॒ = क॒

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

क॒	क॒	क॒	क॒	क॒	क॒
क॒	क॒	क॒	क॒	क॒	क॒

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

kī · क

Add the ī sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

rare long vocalic-ī sign

ka + ī kī

क + क = क

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

क	क	क	क	क	क
क	क	क	क	क	क

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

ke • के

Add the e sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

ka + e ke

क + े = के

upper sign

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

के	के	के	के	के	के
के	के	के	के	के	के

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

kai · कै

Add the ai sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

ka + ai kai क + ^ॐ = कै double upper sign

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

कै	कै	कै	कै	कै	कै
कै	कै	कै	कै	कै	कै

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

ko • को

Add the o sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

ka + o ko क + ी = को upper plus right-side sign

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

को	को	को	को	को	को
को	को	को	को	को	को

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

kau • कौ

Add the au sign to ka. The consonant and sign form one written unit.

BUILD THE SYLLABLE

ka + au kau क + ौ = कौ

upper plus right-side au sign

1. Trace

12 complete syllables

कौ	कौ	कौ	कौ	कौ	कौ
कौ	कौ	कौ	कौ	कौ	कौ

2. Copy

Place the sign precisely

3. Repeat

18 spaces

Virāma and inherent a

A consonant letter normally carries a short a unless a sign or virāma changes it.

SIGN

k

क्

Sound cue: consonant without inherent a

Place the virāma neatly below the consonant.

1. Trace k

12 repetitions

क्	क्	क्	क्	क्	क्
क्	क्	क्	क्	क्	क्

2. Alternate ka / k

Notice the final mark

क	क्	क	क्	क	क्
क	क्	क	क्	क	क्

3. Write from memory

ka, k, ka, k ...

COMPARE

ka क contains the inherent short a. **k क्** uses the virāma or halant् to suppress that vowel. In normal Sanskrit writing, consonant clusters often form conjunct shapes rather than displaying a separate visible virāma.

Consonant-vowel families



Apply every Sanskrit vowel sign to every consonant. Each page gives the inherent-a form followed by the complete mātṛā sequence.

क का की कु

Before you begin

- Read the IAST syllable before tracing the Devanāgarī form.
- Trace each combination twice, then write it three times.
- Check upper, lower, left, and right vowel-sign placement carefully.

ka family • क

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **k**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
ka	क	क	क			
kā	का	का	का			
ki	कि	कि	कि			
kī	की	की	की			
ku	कु	कु	कु			
kū	कू	कू	कू			
kṛ	कृ	कृ	कृ			
kṛī	कृी	कृी	कृी			
kḷ	कळ	कळ	कळ			
kḷī	कळी	कळी	कळी			
ke	के	के	के			
kai	कै	कै	कै			
ko	को	को	को			
kau	कौ	कौ	कौ			

Sound group: guttural. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

kha family • ख

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **kh**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE		WRITE THREE TIMES		
kha	ख	ख	ख			
khā	खा	खा	खा			
khi	खि	खि	खि			
khī	खी	खी	खी			
khu	खु	खु	खु			
khū	खू	खू	खू			
khṛ	खृ	खृ	खृ			
khṝ	खृ̄	खृ̄	खृ̄			
khḷ	खळ	खळ	खळ			
khḹ	खळ̄	खळ̄	खळ̄			
khe	खे	खे	खे			
khai	खै	खै	खै			
kho	खो	खो	खो			
khau	खौ	खौ	खौ			

Sound group: guttural. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ga family • ग

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **g**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
ga	ग	ग	ग			
gā	गा	गा	गा			
gi	गि	गि	गि			
gī	गी	गी	गी			
gu	गु	गु	गु			
gū	गू	गू	गू			
gr	गृ	गृ	गृ			
grī	गृ	गृ	गृ			
gl	ग्ल	ग्ल	ग्ल			
glī	ग्ल	ग्ल	ग्ल			
ge	गे	गे	गे			
gai	गै	गै	गै			
go	गो	गो	गो			
gau	गौ	गौ	गौ			

Sound group: guttural. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

gha family • घ

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **gh**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE		WRITE THREE TIMES		
gha	घ	घ	घ			
ghā	घा	घा	घा			
ghi	घि	घि	घि			
ghī	घी	घी	घी			
ghu	घु	घु	घु			
ghū	घू	घू	घू			
ghṛ	घृ	घृ	घृ			
ghṝ	घृ̄	घृ̄	घृ̄			
ghṛ̐	घृ̐	घृ̐	घृ̐			
ghṛ̑	घृ̑	घृ̑	घृ̑			
ghe	घे	घे	घे			
ghai	घै	घै	घै			
gho	घो	घो	घो			
ghau	घौ	घौ	घौ			

Sound group: guttural. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ṇa family · ङ

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is ṇ. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST

MODEL

TRACE TWICE

WRITE THREE TIMES

ṇa	ङ	ङ	ङ			
ṇā	ङा	ङा	ङा			
ṇi	ङि	ङि	ङि			
ṇī	ङी	ङी	ङी			
ṇu	ङु	ङु	ङु			
ṇū	ङू	ङू	ङू			
ṇṛ	ङृ	ङृ	ङृ			
ṇṝ	ङॄ	ङॄ	ङॄ			
ṇḷ	ङळ	ङळ	ङळ			
ṇḻ	ङळ	ङळ	ङळ			
ṇe	ङे	ङे	ङे			
ṇai	ङै	ङै	ङै			
ṇo	ङो	ङो	ङो			
ṇau	ङौ	ङौ	ङौ			

Sound group: guttural. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ca family • च

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **c**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
ca	च	च	च			
cā	चा	चा	चा			
ci	चि	चि	चि			
cī	ची	ची	ची			
cu	चु	चु	चु			
cū	चू	चू	चू			
cr̥	चृ	चृ	चृ			
cr̄	चृ	चृ	चृ			
cl̥	च्लृ	च्लृ	च्लृ			
cl̄	च्लृ	च्लृ	च्लृ			
ce	चे	चे	चे			
cai	चै	चै	चै			
co	चो	चो	चो			
cau	चौ	चौ	चौ			

Sound group: palatal. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

cha family · छ

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **ch**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE		WRITE THREE TIMES		
cha	छ	छ	छ			
chā	छा	छा	छा			
chi	छि	छि	छि			
chī	छी	छी	छी			
chu	छु	छु	छु			
chū	छू	छू	छू			
chṛ	छृ	छृ	छृ			
chṝ	छृ̄	छृ̄	छृ̄			
chḷ	छळ	छळ	छळ			
chḹ	छळ̄	छळ̄	छळ̄			
che	छे	छे	छे			
chai	छै	छै	छै			
cho	छो	छो	छो			
chau	छौ	छौ	छौ			

Sound group: palatal. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ja family • ज

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **j**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
ja	ज	ज	ज			
jā	जा	जा	जा			
ji	जि	जि	जि			
jī	जी	जी	जी			
ju	जु	जु	जु			
jū	जू	जू	जू			
jṛ	जृ	जृ	जृ			
jṝ	जृ̄	जृ̄	जृ̄			
jḷ	जळ	जळ	जळ			
jḹ	जळ̄	जळ̄	जळ̄			
je	जे	जे	जे			
jai	जै	जै	जै			
jo	जो	जो	जो			
jau	जौ	जौ	जौ			

Sound group: palatal. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

jha family · झ

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **jh**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
jha	झ	झ	झ			
jhā	झा	झा	झा			
jhi	झि	झि	झि			
jhī	झी	झी	झी			
jhu	झु	झु	झु			
jhū	झू	झू	झू			
jhṛ	झृ	झृ	झृ			
jhṝ	झॄ	झॄ	झॄ			
jhṝ	झॄ	झॄ	झॄ			
jhṝ	झॄ	झॄ	झॄ			
jhe	झे	झे	झे			
jhai	झै	झै	झै			
jho	झो	झो	झो			
jhau	झौ	झौ	झौ			

Sound group: palatal. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ña family • ज

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is ñ. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST

MODEL

TRACE TWICE

WRITE THREE TIMES

ña	ज	ज	ज			
ñā	जा	जा	जा			
ñi	जि	जि	जि			
ñī	जी	जी	जी			
ñu	जु	जु	जु			
ñū	जू	जू	जू			
ñṛ	जृ	जृ	जृ			
ñṝ	जृ	जृ	जृ			
ñḷ	जळ	जळ	जळ			
ñḻ	जळ	जळ	जळ			
ñe	जे	जे	जे			
ñai	जै	जै	जै			
ño	जो	जो	जो			
ñau	जौ	जौ	जौ			

Sound group: palatal. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ṭa family · ट

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **ṭ**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
ṭa	ट	ट	ट			
ṭā	टा	टा	टा			
ṭi	टी	टी	टी			
ṭī	टी	टी	टी			
ṭu	टु	टु	टु			
ṭū	टू	टू	टू			
ṭṛ	ट्र	ट्र	ट्र			
ṭṛ	ट्र	ट्र	ट्र			
ṭl	ṭḷ	ṭḷ	ṭḷ			
ṭl	ṭḷ	ṭḷ	ṭḷ			
ṭe	टे	टे	टे			
ṭai	टै	टै	टै			
ṭo	टो	टो	टो			
ṭau	टौ	टौ	टौ			

Sound group: retroflex. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ṭha family · ठ

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **ṭh**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST

MODEL

TRACE TWICE

WRITE THREE TIMES

ṭha	ठ	ठ	ठ			
ṭhā	ठा	ठा	ठा			
ṭhi	ठी	ठी	ठी			
ṭhī	ठी	ठी	ठी			
ṭhu	ठु	ठु	ठु			
ṭhū	ठू	ठू	ठू			
ṭṛ	ṛ	ṛ	ṛ			
ṭṝ	ṝ	ṝ	ṝ			
ṭḷ	ḷ	ḷ	ḷ			
ṭḹ	ḹ	ḹ	ḹ			
ṭe	ṛे	ṛे	ṛे			
ṭhai	ṛै	ṛै	ṛै			
ṭho	ठो	ठो	ठो			
ṭhau	ठौ	ठौ	ठौ			

Sound group: retroflex. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ḍa family • ङ

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is ḍ. The first row has inherent a; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
ḍa	ङ	ङ	ङ			
ḍā	ङा	ङा	ङा			
ḍi	ङि	ङि	ङि			
ḍī	ङी	ङी	ङी			
ḍu	ङु	ङु	ङु			
ḍū	ङू	ङू	ङू			
ḍṛ	ङृ	ङृ	ङृ			
ḍṛī	ङृी	ङृी	ङृी			
ḍl	ङळ	ङळ	ङळ			
ḍlī	ङळी	ङळी	ङळी			
ḍe	ङे	ङे	ङे			
ḍai	ङै	ङै	ङै			
ḍo	ङो	ङो	ङो			
ḍau	ङौ	ङौ	ङौ			

Sound group: retroflex. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ḍha family · ढ

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **ḍh**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST

MODEL

TRACE TWICE

WRITE THREE TIMES

ḍha	ढ	ढ	ढ			
ḍhā	ढा	ढा	ढा			
ḍhi	ढि	ढि	ढि			
ḍhī	ढी	ढी	ढी			
ḍhu	ढु	ढु	ढु			
ḍhū	ढू	ढू	ढू			
ḍṛ	ढ्र	ढ्र	ढ्र			
ḍṝ	ढ्र̄	ढ्र̄	ढ्र̄			
ḍḷ	ढळ	ढळ	ढळ			
ḍḹ	ढळ̄	ढळ̄	ढळ̄			
ḍhe	ढे	ढे	ढे			
ḍhai	ढै	ढै	ढै			
ḍho	ढो	ढो	ढो			
ḍhau	ढौ	ढौ	ढौ			

Sound group: retroflex. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ṇa family · ण

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is ṇ. The first row has inherent a; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
ṇa	ण	ण	ण			
ṇā	णा	णा	णा			
ṇi	णि	णि	णि			
ṇī	णी	णी	णी			
ṇu	णु	णु	णु			
ṇū	णू	णू	णू			
ṇṛ	णृ	णृ	णृ			
ṇṝ	णॄ	णॄ	णॄ			
ṇḷ	णळ	णळ	णळ			
ṇḻ	णळ	णळ	णळ			
ṇe	णे	णे	णे			
ṇai	णै	णै	णै			
ṇo	णो	णो	णो			
ṇau	णौ	णौ	णौ			

Sound group: retroflex. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ta family · त

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **t**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
ta	त	त	त			
tā	ता	ता	ता			
ti	ति	ति	ति			
tī	ती	ती	ती			
tu	तु	तु	तु			
tū	तू	तू	तू			
ṭṛ	टृ	टृ	टृ			
ṭṛī	टृी	टृी	टृी			
ṭṛi	टृि	टृि	टृि			
tṛ	त्र	त्र	त्र			
tṛī	त्री	त्री	त्री			
te	ते	ते	ते			
tai	तै	तै	तै			
to	तो	तो	तो			
tau	तौ	तौ	तौ			

tha family · थ

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **th**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE		WRITE THREE TIMES		
tha	थ	थ	थ			
thā	था	था	था			
thi	थि	थि	थि			
thī	थी	थी	थी			
thu	थु	थु	थु			
thū	थू	थू	थू			
thṛ	थृ	थृ	थृ			
thṝ	थृ̄	थृ̄	थृ̄			
thḷ	थळ	थळ	थळ			
thḹ	थळ̄	थळ̄	थळ̄			
the	थे	थे	थे			
thai	थै	थै	थै			
tho	थो	थो	थो			
thau	थौ	थौ	थौ			

Sound group: dental. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

da family · द

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **d**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
da	द	द	द			
dā	दा	दा	दा			
di	दि	दि	दि			
dī	दी	दी	दी			
du	दु	दु	दु			
dū	दू	दू	दू			
ḍṛ	ḍṛ	ḍṛ	ḍṛ			
dṝ	दृ	दृ	दृ			
ḍḷ	ḍḷ	ḍḷ	ḍḷ			
dḹ	ḍḻ	ḍḻ	ḍḻ			
de	दे	दे	दे			
dai	दै	दै	दै			
do	दो	दो	दो			
dau	दौ	दौ	दौ			

Sound group: dental. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

dha family · ध

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **dh**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE		WRITE THREE TIMES		
dha	ध	ध	ध			
dhā	धा	धा	धा			
dhi	धि	धि	धि			
dhī	धी	धी	धी			
dhu	धु	धु	धु			
dhū	धू	धू	धू			
dhṛ	धृ	धृ	धृ			
dhṝ	धृ̄	धृ̄	धृ̄			
dhḷ	धळ	धळ	धळ			
dhḹ	धळ̄	धळ̄	धळ̄			
dhe	धे	धे	धे			
dhai	धै	धै	धै			
dho	धो	धो	धो			
dhau	धौ	धौ	धौ			

Sound group: dental. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

na family · न

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **n**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
na	न	न	न			
nā	ना	ना	ना			
ni	नि	नि	नि			
nī	नी	नी	नी			
nu	नु	नु	नु			
nū	नू	नू	नू			
nṛ	नृ	नृ	नृ			
nṝ	नृ̄	नृ̄	नृ̄			
nḷ	नळ	नळ	नळ			
nḹ	नळ̄	नळ̄	नळ̄			
ne	ने	ने	ने			
nai	नै	नै	नै			
no	नो	नो	नो			
nau	नौ	नौ	नौ			

pa family • प

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **p**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST

MODEL

TRACE TWICE

WRITE THREE TIMES

pa	प	प	प			
pā	पा	पा	पा			
pi	पि	पि	पि			
pī	पी	पी	पी			
pu	पु	पु	पु			
pū	पू	पू	पू			
pr	प्र	प्र	प्र			
pṛ	पृ	पृ	पृ			
pṝ	पृ̄	पृ̄	पृ̄			
pl	प्ल	प्ल	प्ल			
pḷ	प्लृ	प्लृ	प्लृ			
pe	पे	पे	पे			
pai	पै	पै	पै			
po	पो	पो	पो			
pau	पौ	पौ	पौ			

Sound group: labial. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

pha family · फ

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **ph**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
pha	फ	फ	फ			
phā	फा	फा	फा			
phi	फि	फि	फि			
phī	फी	फी	फी			
phu	फु	फु	फु			
phū	फू	फू	फू			
phṛ	फृ	फृ	फृ			
phṝ	फृ̄	फृ̄	फृ̄			
phl̥	फ़्ल	फ़्ल	फ़्ल			
phl̥̄	फ़्ल̄	फ़्ल̄	फ़्ल̄			
phe	फे	फे	फे			
phai	फै	फै	फै			
pho	फो	फो	फो			
phau	फौ	फौ	फौ			

Sound group: labial. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ba family • ब

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **b**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
ba	ब	ब	ब			
bā	बा	बा	बा			
bi	बि	बि	बि			
bī	बी	बी	बी			
bu	बु	बु	बु			
bū	बू	बू	बू			
br̥	बृ	बृ	बृ			
br̄	ब्र	ब्र	ब्र			
bḷ	बळ	बळ	बळ			
bḻ	बळ	बळ	बळ			
be	बे	बे	बे			
bai	बै	बै	बै			
bo	बो	बो	बो			
bau	बौ	बौ	बौ			

Sound group: labial. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

bha family · भ

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **bh**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE		WRITE THREE TIMES		
bha	भ	भ	भ			
bhā	भा	भा	भा			
bhi	भि	भि	भि			
bhī	भी	भी	भी			
bhu	भु	भु	भु			
bhū	भू	भू	भू			
bhṛ	भृ	भृ	भृ			
bhṝ	भृ̄	भृ̄	भृ̄			
bhṛ̐	भृ̐	भृ̐	भृ̐			
bhṛ̑	भृ̑	भृ̑	भृ̑			
bhe	भे	भे	भे			
bhai	भै	भै	भै			
bho	भो	भो	भो			
bhau	भौ	भौ	भौ			

Sound group: labial. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ma family · म

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **m**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
ma	म	म	म			
mā	मा	मा	मा			
mi	मि	मि	मि			
mī	मी	मी	मी			
mu	मु	मु	मु			
mū	मू	मू	मू			
mṛ	मृ	मृ	मृ			
mṝ	मृ̄	मृ̄	मृ̄			
mḷ	मळ	मळ	मळ			
mḹ	मळ̄	मळ̄	मळ̄			
me	मे	मे	मे			
mai	मै	मै	मै			
mo	मो	मो	मो			
mau	मौ	मौ	मौ			

Sound group: labial. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ya family • य

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **y**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
ya	य	य	य			
yā	या	या	या			
yi	यि	यि	यि			
yī	यी	यी	यी			
yu	यु	यु	यु			
yū	यू	यू	यू			
yṛ	यृ	यृ	यृ			
yṝ	यॄ	यॄ	यॄ			
yḷ	यळ	यळ	यळ			
yḹ	यळॄ	यळॄ	यळॄ			
ye	ये	ये	ये			
yai	यै	यै	यै			
yo	यो	यो	यो			
yau	यौ	यौ	यौ			

Sound group: semivowel. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ra family • र

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **r**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
ra	र	र	र			
rā	रा	रा	रा			
ri	रि	रि	रि			
rī	री	री	री			
ru	रु	रु	रु			
rū	रू	रू	रू			
rṛ	रृ	रृ	रृ			
rṝ	रॄ	रॄ	रॄ			
rṝ̄	रॱ	रॱ	रॱ			
rē	रे	रे	रे			
rai	रै	रै	रै			
ro	रो	रो	रो			
rau	रौ	रौ	रौ			

Sound group: semivowel. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

la family • ल

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **l**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
la	ल	ल	ल			
lā	ला	ला	ला			
li	लि	लि	लि			
lī	ली	ली	ली			
lu	लु	लु	लु			
lū	लू	लू	लू			
lṛ	लृ	लृ	लृ			
lṝ	लृ̄	लृ̄	लृ̄			
lḷ	लळ	लळ	लळ			
lḹ	लळ̄	लळ̄	लळ̄			
le	ले	ले	ले			
lai	लै	लै	लै			
lo	लो	लो	लो			
lau	लौ	लौ	लौ			

Sound group: semivowel. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

va family • व

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **v**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST

MODEL

TRACE TWICE

WRITE THREE TIMES

va	व	व	व			
vā	वा	वा	वा			
vi	वि	वि	वि			
vī	वी	वी	वी			
vu	वु	वु	वु			
vū	वू	वू	वू			
vṛ	वृ	वृ	वृ			
vṛī	वृी	वृी	वृी			
vḷ	वळ	वळ	वळ			
vḷī	वळी	वळी	वळी			
ve	वे	वे	वे			
vai	वै	वै	वै			
vo	वो	वो	वो			
vau	वौ	वौ	वौ			

Sound group: semivowel. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

śa family · श

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is ś. The first row has inherent a; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST

MODEL

TRACE TWICE

WRITE THREE TIMES

śa	श	श	श			
śā	शा	शा	शा			
śi	शि	शि	शि			
śī	शी	शी	शी			
śu	शु	शु	शु			
śū	शू	शू	शू			
śṛ	शृ	शृ	शृ			
śṝ	शृ̄	शृ̄	शृ̄			
śṛ̌	शृ̌	शृ̌	शृ̌			
śṛ̍	शृ̍	शृ̍	शृ̍			
śe	शे	शे	शे			
śai	शै	शै	शै			
śo	शो	शो	शो			
śau	शौ	शौ	शौ			

Sound group: sibilant. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ṣa family • ष

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is ṣ. The first row has inherent a; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
ṣa	ष	ष	ष			
ṣā	षा	षा	षा			
ṣi	षि	षि	षि			
ṣī	षी	षी	षी			
ṣu	षु	षु	षु			
ṣū	षू	षू	षू			
ṣṛ	षृ	षृ	षृ			
ṣṝ	षॄ	षॄ	षॄ			
ṣḷ	षळ	षळ	षळ			
ṣḻ	षळ	षळ	षळ			
ṣe	षे	षे	षे			
ṣai	षै	षै	षै			
ṣo	षो	षो	षो			
ṣau	षौ	षौ	षौ			

Sound group: sibilant. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

sa family · स

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **s**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
sa	स	स	स			
sā	सा	सा	सा			
si	सि	सि	सि			
sī	सी	सी	सी			
su	सु	सु	सु			
sū	सू	सू	सू			
ṣṛ	सृ	सृ	सृ			
sṝ	सृ	सृ	सृ			
ṣḷ	सृ	सृ	सृ			
sḹ	सृ	सृ	सृ			
se	से	से	से			
sai	सै	सै	सै			
so	सो	सो	सो			
sau	सौ	सौ	सौ			

Sound group: sibilant. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

ha family · ह

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is **h**. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
ha	ह	ह	ह			
hā	हा	हा	हा			
hi	हि	हि	हि			
hī	ही	ही	ही			
hu	हु	हु	हु			
hū	हू	हू	हू			
hṛ	ह्र	ह्र	ह्र			
hṛī	ह्री	ह्री	ह्री			
hṛī	ह्री	ह्री	ह्री			
hṛī	ह्री	ह्री	ह्री			
he	हे	हे	हे			
hai	है	है	है			
ho	हो	हो	हो			
hau	हौ	हौ	हौ			

Sound group: aspirate. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.

la family · ལ

Trace each complete syllable twice, then write it three times.

READ THE WHOLE SYLLABLE

The consonant is ལ. The first row has inherent **a**; every later row adds a visible vowel sign.

IAST	MODEL	TRACE TWICE			WRITE THREE TIMES	
la	ལ	ལ	ལ			
lā	ལཱ	ལཱ	ལཱ			
li	ལི	ལི	ལི			
lī	ལཱི	ལཱི	ལཱི			
lu	ལུ	ལུ	ལུ			
lū	ལུཾ	ལུཾ	ལུཾ			
lr	ལུརྟ	ལུརྟ	ལུརྟ			
lṛ	ལུརྟཾ	ལུརྟཾ	ལུརྟཾ			
ll	ལུཾ	ལུཾ	ལུཾ			
lī	ལུཾ	ལུཾ	ལུཾ			
le	ལེ	ལེ	ལེ			
lai	ལེཾ	ལེཾ	ལེཾ			
lo	ལོ	ལོ	ལོ			
lau	ལོཾ	ལོཾ	ལོཾ			

Sound group: supplement. Review the individual vowel-sign pages if placement is uncertain.



Consonant joining

Consonants combine when no vowel intervenes. Learn the virāma logic first, then practice half-forms, rakāra, repha, doubling, nasal-stop joins, and special conjuncts.

क् + य = क्य

Before you begin

- These formations belong to spelling and handwriting, not the basic alphabet.
- Read each IAST sequence from left to right before studying the written shape.
- Trace the joined form, then reproduce it without the model.

How consonants combine

A virāma removes the inherent a; handwriting and typography then reshape the cluster.

FULL CONSONANT

ka

क

The full letter ka contains inherent a.

VISIBLE VIRĀMA

k

क्

The virāma suppresses a when the consonant stands unjoined.

HALF-FORM JOIN

kya

क्य

The first consonant is reduced before ya.

RAKĀRA

kra

क्र्

Ra follows the consonant as an attached form.

REPHA

rka

र्क

Ra comes first but is written above the following consonant.

SPECIAL JOIN

kta

क्त

Some combinations reshape more strongly and must be practiced.

READING ORDER

Read the IAST from left to right. A written cluster still represents an ordered consonant sequence. The practice pages that follow teach formations, not additional basic alphabet letters.

Half-forms before ya I

The first consonant loses its inherent a and joins ya.

kya

क्य

क् + य = क्य

The right stem of ka is reduced before ya.

TRACE

क्य

क्य

क्य

WRITE

gya

ग्य

ग् + य = ग्य

This is gya, not the separate cluster jña.

TRACE

ग्य

ग्य

ग्य

WRITE

tya

त्य

त् + य = त्य

Ta takes a reduced form before ya.

TRACE

त्य

त्य

त्य

WRITE

pya

प्य

प् + य = प्य

Pa joins directly to ya.

TRACE

प्य

प्य

प्य

WRITE

Half-forms before ya II

Compare the reduced first consonant in four more common joins.

khya

ख्य

ख् + य = ख्य

Keep the aspirated kha identity visible.

TRACE

ख्य

ख्य

ख्य

WRITE

dya

द्य

द् + य = द्य

Frequent in words such as vidyā.

TRACE

द्य

द्य

द्य

WRITE

dhya

ध्य

ध् + य = ध्य

Frequent in words such as dhyāna.

TRACE

ध्य

ध्य

ध्य

WRITE

nya

न्य

न् + य = न्य

Keep the reduced na distinct from other nasals.

TRACE

न्य

न्य

न्य

WRITE

Rakāra I

When ra follows a consonant, it often appears as a diagonal or lower attachment.

kra

क्

क् + र = क्

Ra follows ka as a rakāra sign.

TRACE

क्

क्

क्

WRITE

gra

ग्

ग् + र = ग्

Keep the ra attachment light and clear.

TRACE

ग्

ग्

ग्

WRITE

pra

प्

प् + र = प्

A frequent Sanskrit cluster and prefix shape.

TRACE

प्

प्

प्

WRITE

bra

ब्

ब् + र = ब्

Do not confuse ba with va before rakāra.

TRACE

ब्

ब्

ब्

WRITE

Rakāra II

These joins also place ra after the first consonant.

tra

त्

त् + र = त्र

A conjunct formation, taught here rather than in the basic alphabet.

TRACE

त्

त्

त्

WRITE

dra

द्

द् + र = द्र

The ra attachment follows da.

TRACE

द्

द्

द्

WRITE

bhra

भ्र

भ्र + र = भ्र

Keep bha's inner detail visible.

TRACE

भ्र

भ्र

भ्र

WRITE

śra

श्र

श्र + र = श्र

Frequent in Sanskrit words such as śrī.

TRACE

श्र

श्र

श्र

WRITE

Additional rakāra forms

Some consonants retain a fuller body or use a distinctive ra attachment.

ṭra

ट्र

ट् + र = ट्र

Retroflex ṭa retains its rounded body.

TRACE

ट्र

ट्र

ट्र

WRITE

ḍra

ड्र

ड् + र = ड्र

Retroflex ḍa retains its rounded body.

TRACE

ड्र

ड्र

ड्र

WRITE

hra

ह्र

ह् + र = ह्र

Keep the lower ra mark separate from ha's body.

TRACE

ह्र

ह्र

ह्र

WRITE

vra

व्र

व् + र = व्र

A compact join of va and ra.

TRACE

व्र

व्र

व्र

WRITE

Repha: ra comes first

Initial r loses its vowel and is written above the following consonant.

rka

रक

र + क = र्क

The upper mark is repha; pronounce r before ka.

TRACE

र्क

र्क

र्क

WRITE

rga

रग

र + ग = र्ग

Pronounce r before ga.

TRACE

र्ग

र्ग

र्ग

WRITE

rta

रत

र + त = र्त

Pronounce r before ta.

TRACE

र्त

र्त

र्त

WRITE

rma

रम

र + म = र्म

Pronounce r before ma.

TRACE

र्म

र्म

र्म

WRITE

Joins with la

La follows a consonant without an intervening vowel.

kla

क्ल

क् + ल = क्ल

Ka takes a reduced form before la.

TRACE

क्ल

क्ल

क्ल

WRITE

gla

ग्ल

ग् + ल = ग्ल

Keep la's tall stem straight.

TRACE

ग्ल

ग्ल

ग्ल

WRITE

pla

प्ल

प् + ल = प्ल

Pa joins directly to la.

TRACE

प्ल

प्ल

प्ल

WRITE

śla

श्ल

श् + ल = श्ल

Frequent in the word śloka.

TRACE

श्ल

श्ल

श्ल

WRITE

Joins with va

Va follows a consonant without an intervening vowel.

kva**क्व**

क् + व = क्व

Ka takes a reduced form before va.

TRACE

क्व

क्व

क्व

WRITE

tva**त्वं**

त् + व = त्व

Frequent in pronouns and abstract nouns.

TRACE

त्वं

त्वं

त्वं

WRITE

dva**द्व**

द् + व = द्व

Frequent in words beginning dvi- or dva-.

TRACE

द्व

द्व

द्व

WRITE

śva**श्व**

श् + व = श्व

Frequent in aśva, 'horse.'

TRACE

श्व

श्व

श्व

WRITE

Doubled consonants I

The first copy loses its vowel; the second carries the syllable vowel.

kka

क्क

क् + क = क्क

Hold the k closure across both consonants.

TRACE

क्क

क्क

क्क

WRITE

cca

च्च

च् + च = च्च

Keep the two c sounds distinct in slow reading.

TRACE

च्च

च्च

च्च

WRITE

ṭṭa

ट्ट

ट् + ट = ट्ट

A doubled retroflex consonant.

TRACE

ट्ट

ट्ट

ट्ट

WRITE

tta

त्त

त् + त = त्त

A doubled dental consonant.

TRACE

त्त

त्त

त्त

WRITE

Doubled consonants II

Practice four more consonants with no vowel between the pair.

dda

द्द

द् + द = द्द

A doubled voiced dental consonant.

TRACE

द्द

द्द

द्द

WRITE

nna

न्न

न् + न = न्न

A doubled dental nasal.

TRACE

न्न

न्न

न्न

WRITE

mma

म्म

म् + म = म्म

A doubled labial nasal.

TRACE

म्म

म्म

म्म

WRITE

lla

ल्ल

ल् + ल = ल्ल

A doubled lateral consonant.

TRACE

ल्ल

ल्ल

ल्ल

WRITE

Nasal-stop joins I

A class nasal joins a stop made at the same place of articulation.

ñka

ङ्क

ङ् + क = ङ्क

Guttural nasal before ka.

TRACE

ङ्क

ङ्क

ङ्क

WRITE

ñga

ङ्ग

ङ् + ग = ङ्ग

Guttural nasal before ga.

TRACE

ङ्ग

ङ्ग

ङ्ग

WRITE

ñca

ञ्च

ञ् + च = ञ्च

Palatal nasal before ca.

TRACE

ञ्च

ञ्च

ञ्च

WRITE

ñja

ञ्ज

ञ् + ज = ञ्ज

Palatal nasal before ja.

TRACE

ञ्ज

ञ्ज

ञ्ज

WRITE

Nasal-stop joins II

Keep the nasal's place of articulation matched to the following stop.

ṇṭa

ण्ट

ण् + ट = ण्ट

Retroflex nasal before ṭa.

TRACE

ण्ट

ण्ट

ण्ट

WRITE

ṇḍa

ण्ड

ण् + ड = ण्ड

Retroflex nasal before ḍa.

TRACE

ण्ड

ण्ड

ण्ड

WRITE

ṇta

न्त

ण् + त = न्त

Dental nasal before ta.

TRACE

न्त

न्त

न्त

WRITE

ṇda

न्द

ण् + द = न्द

Dental nasal before da.

TRACE

न्द

न्द

न्द

WRITE

Nasal-stop joins III

Read the nasal and stop together while preserving both values.

ntha

न्थ

न् + थ = न्थ

Dental nasal before aspirated tha.

TRACE

न्थ

न्थ

न्थ

WRITE

ndha

न्ध

न् + ध = न्ध

Dental nasal before aspirated dha.

TRACE

न्ध

न्ध

न्ध

WRITE

mpa

म्प

म् + प = म्प

Labial nasal before pa.

TRACE

म्प

म्प

म्प

WRITE

mba

म्ब

म् + ब = म्ब

Labial nasal before ba.

TRACE

म्ब

म्ब

म्ब

WRITE

Sibilant clusters I

A sibilant loses its inherent vowel before the following consonant.

ska

स्क्

स् + क = स्क्

Sa takes a reduced form before ka.

TRACE

स्क्

स्क्

स्क्

WRITE

sta

स्त

स् + त = स्त

Frequent throughout Sanskrit.

TRACE

स्त

स्त

स्त

WRITE

stha

स्थ

स् + थ = स्थ

Keep the aspiration of tha.

TRACE

स्थ

स्थ

स्थ

WRITE

sna

स्न

स् + न = स्न

Keep both consonants audible.

TRACE

स्न

स्न

स्न

WRITE

Sibilant clusters II

Compare sa and retroflex ṣa before different consonants.

sma

स्म

स् + म = स्म

Frequent in pronouns and verbal forms.

TRACE

स्म

स्म

स्म

WRITE

spa

स्प

स् + प = स्प

Keep pa unaspirated.

TRACE

स्प

स्प

स्प

WRITE

ṣṭa

ष्ट

ष् + ट = ष्ट

Both consonants are retroflex.

TRACE

ष्ट

ष्ट

ष्ट

WRITE

ṣṭha

ष्ठ

ष् + ठ = ष्ठ

Keep ṭha aspirated.

TRACE

ष्ठ

ष्ठ

ष्ठ

WRITE

Special conjunct construction

These shapes change more strongly, so analyze the parts before memorizing the result.

кта**क्त्**

क् + त = क्त्

Frequent in participles and verbal derivatives.

TRACE

क्त्

क्त्

क्त्

WRITE

क्त्वा**क्त्वं**

क् + त् + व = क्त्वं

A three-consonant cluster used in -tvā forms.

TRACE

क्त्वं

क्त्वं

क्त्वं

WRITE

क्ष**क्ष**

क् + ष = क्ष

A conjunct formation, not placed in the basic alphabet.

TRACE

क्ष

क्ष

क्ष

WRITE

ज्ञ**ज्ज**

ज् + ज = ज्ज

A conjunct formation, not placed in the basic alphabet.

TRACE

ज्ज

ज्ज

ज्ज

WRITE



Basic Sanskrit words

Now connect letters into meaningful units. Read the IAST, identify vowel signs and conjuncts, then write the whole word with even spacing.

गुरु फल मतिर्

Before you begin

- Say the word before writing it.
- Trace the full word without lifting the pencil unnecessarily.
- Check every mātrā and conjunct before repeating from memory.

Word practice 1

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

aśva	अश्व	horse
Trace 3 times		
अश्व	अश्व	अश्व
Copy 6 spaces		

agni	अग्नि	fire
Trace 3 times		
अग्नि	अग्नि	अग्नि
Copy 6 spaces		

Word practice 2

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

jala

जल

water

Trace

3 times

जल	जल	जल
----	----	----

Copy

6 spaces

phala

फल

fruit

Trace

3 times

फल	फल	फल
----	----	----

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 3

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

vana

वन

forest

Trace

3 times

वन	वन	वन
----	----	----

Copy

6 spaces

gaja

गज

elephant

Trace

3 times

गज	गज	गज
----	----	----

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 4

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

rāma

राम

Rāma

Trace

3 times

राम	राम	राम
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

sītā

सीता

Sītā

Trace

3 times

सीता	सीता	सीता
------	------	------

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 5

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

guru

गुरु

teacher

Trace

3 times

गुरु	गुरु	गुरु
------	------	------

Copy

6 spaces

mātā

माता

mother

Trace

3 times

माता	माता	माता
------	------	------

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 6

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

pitā

पति

father

Trace

3 times

पति	पति	पति
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

deva

देव

deity

Trace

3 times

देव	देव	देव
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 7

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

yoga

योग

yoga

Trace

3 times

योग	योग	योग
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

namah

नमः

salutation

Trace

3 times

नमः	नमः	नमः
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 8

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

pustaka

पुस्तक

book

Trace

3 times

पुस्तक	पुस्तक	पुस्तक
--------	--------	--------

Copy

6 spaces

kamala

कमल

lotus

Trace

3 times

कमल	कमल	कमल
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 9

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

bāla

बाल

child, boy

Trace

3 times

बाल	बाल	बाल
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

bālā

बाला

girl

Trace

3 times

बाला	बाला	बाला
------	------	------

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 10

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

sūrya

सूर्य

sun

Trace

3 times

सूर्य	सूर्य	सूर्य
-------	-------	-------

Copy

6 spaces

candra

चन्द्र

moon

Trace

3 times

चन्द्र	चन्द्र	चन्द्र
--------	--------	--------

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 11

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

mitra

मतिर्

friend

Trace

3 times

मतिर्	मतिर्	मतिर्
-------	-------	-------

Copy

6 spaces

gr̥ha

गृह

home

Trace

3 times

गृह	गृह	गृह
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

Word practice 12

Read IAST, say the meaning, trace the full Devanāgarī word, then copy it.

nadi

नदी

river

Trace

3 times

नदी	नदी	नदी
-----	-----	-----

Copy

6 spaces

bhārata

भारत

India

Trace

3 times

भारत	भारत	भारत
------	------	------

Copy

6 spaces

Digits 0-4

Trace each digit, then fill the empty cells.

0 • śūnya

०

०	०	०	०	०	०

1 • eka

१

१	१	१	१	१	१

2 • dvi

२

२	२	२	२	२	२

3 • tri

३

३	३	३	३	३	३

4 • catur

४

४	४	४	४	४	४

Digits 5-9

Trace each digit, then fill the empty cells.

5 • pañca

५

५	५	५	५	५	५

6 • ṣaṭ

६

६	६	६	६	६	६

7 • sapta

७

७	७	७	७	७	७

8 • aṣṭa

८

८	८	८	८	८	८

9 • nava

९

९	९	९	९	९	९

Mixed letter review

Write without tracing. Check the reference map only after each row.

Vowels

a ā i ī u ū

Gutturals

Check after writing: अ आ इ ई उ ऊ
ka kha ga gha ṇa

Palatals

Check after writing: क ख ग घ ङ
ca cha ja jha ṇa

Retroflex

Check after writing: च छ ज झ ञ
ṭa ṭha ḍa ḍha ṇa

Dentals

Check after writing: ट ठ ड ढ ण
ta tha ḍa ḍha na

Labials

Check after writing: प फ ब भ म
pa pha ba bha ma

Check after writing: प फ ब भ म

Mixed word review

Write without tracing. Check the reference map only after each row.

aśva horse

Check after writing: अश्व

guru teacher

Check after writing: गुरु

pustaka book

Check after writing: पुस्तक

sūrya sun

Check after writing: सूर्य

mitra friend

Check after writing: मित्र

bhārata India

Check after writing: भारत

My handwriting milestone

Return to any page whenever a form needs more practice.

अक्षराभ्यासः

akṣarābhyāsaḥ · letter practice

I completed the Devanāgarī Handwriting Practice Book.

learner

date

Design basis and further guidance

- **Cambridge Sanskrit, Devanagari Practice A4.** The trace-then-copy progression and top-line alignment convention informed this book's original practice grids. cambridge-sanskrit.org
- **NCERT, Vidya Pravesh.** Its foundational-stage guidance on pre-writing lines, curves, outline tracing, and fine-motor development informed the warm-up sequence. ncert.nic.in
- **Originality note.** All page layouts, wording, practice sequences, and vector guides in this book are original. No scanned workbook pages or third-party letter illustrations are reproduced.

KEEP GOING

Next, copy one short Sanskrit sentence per day. Preserve the headline, vowel-sign placement, and even spacing between words.